

GCCN Lean Startup Checklist (~\$1.5k path)

Gulf Coast Charters Network · gulfcoastprivatecharters.com · Asset-light · ~12% take · high-AOV private path

Print and check off in order. \$ amounts are estimates/ASSUMPTIONS except domain ~\$10.46. Absolute DIY floor — Accounting responsible seed is ~\$8–12k. Never skip COI/USCG before live guest money.

Cash map (~\$1,500)

Slice	Budget
Domain + LLC + phone + print/QR	~\$250–350
Dock gas / misc	~\$100–150
Weather / refund buffer (do not spend on OpEx)	~\$500–700
Contingency	~\$300–400

Week 0 — Cash out (~\$300–400)

- Buy domain gulfcoastprivatecharters.com (~\$11, Cloudflare Registrar)
- Cloudflare Email Routing → inbox (book@ / hello@ / captains@)
- File Alabama LLC (DIY) — confirm SOS fee (~\$200 buffer)
- Get free IRS EIN
- Open business bank account (LLC + EIN) — required before live Stripe payouts
- Cheap business phone (Google Voice or lowest OpenPhone) (~\$15)

Week 1 — Stack (~\$0)

- Create Stripe account (start in Test mode)
- Attach business bank + EIN in Stripe before going Live
- Vercel: import mightyorganix-dev/gulf-coast-charters-network
- Connect custom domain · HTTPS green
- Add STRIPE_SECRET_KEY only in Vercel env (never GitHub / chat)
- Keep enabled:false until Test deposit works; then Live + small refundable test
- GA4 + Search Console + claim Google Business Profile

Week 1–2 — Supply (gas ~\$100)

- Dock visits — Captains Portfolio top 5 (one signature private trip each)
- Collect COI + USCG proof before any captain goes live (non-negotiable)
- Signed simple operator / IC agreement on file (template OK; counsel later)
- Replace demo seed with 3–5 real Items (calendar, real price, real photos OK)
- Hide party / jet ski / cheap seats from homepage (high-AOV only)

Week 2 — Prove money

- Soft-launch: 3–5 trusted guests complete real small Stripe deposits
- Refund / complete at least one test cleanly
- Confirm: deposit → itinerary → weather Green/Yellow/Red (manual text OK)
- Do not spend guest deposit float on OpEx or personal bills

Hold until first real revenue / soft-launch works

- Paid ads
- Pro photography budget
- Full counsel polish (quote now; buy before public ad scale)
- E&O; / cyber policy (quote now; required before public scale)
- OTAs / FareHarbor as primary
- Hiring CX / contractors

Stop rules

- No COI / USCG → no public Book Now
- Test deposit fails → do not flip Live keys
- No business bank in Stripe → stay in Test; no real guest money
- Weather buffer empty in peak season → pause new bookings until topped up

Business bank — why / when

When	Need bank?
Building site / GitHub Pages preview	No
Stripe Test mode	No
Live guest deposits + Stripe payouts	YES
Separating deposits / captain payouts from personal cash	YES

Order: LLC + EIN → business checking → attach in Stripe → then Live deposits.